

Japan Electronic Components: New iPhones launched: Apple impact on a downtrend; no major surprises from the event; Eyes on three stocks

Early morning on September 10 (Japan time), Apple (covered by US Hardware/Telecom Technology analyst: Michael Ng) announced the launch of the iPhone 18 Pro/Pro Max and its first foldable smartphone, the iPhone Duo. Prices are set to start at 1,199 USD for the Pro and 1,299 USD for the Pro Max, each 100 USD higher compared to last year's models. In addition, the iPhone Duo is the thinnest Apple iPhone ever when open, equipped with one battery on the left and right side each. When using the inner display, up to 31 hours of video playback is possible, and when using the outer display, up to 44 hours of video playback is possible (for reference, this compares to up to 45 hours for the 18 Pro Max). The Duo adopts Apple's proprietary C2 modem, which realizes power savings. The price will start at 1,999 USD.

While many investors were concerned about the risk that price hikes for the new iPhones would reduce demand and be negative for Japanese electronic component makers as a whole, investor feedback post Apple's new models launch suggests there were no surprises in the iPhone 18 pricing announced this time, and the Duo's pricing appears generally as expected when compared to the concerns previously expressed by some investors. Of course, it is necessary to monitor future sales and electronic component demand, but we believe there are likely no major surprises from event, at least for now. Furthermore, we surmise that this move aligns with the views of Japanese electronic component companies, who had expected the announcement of the base model iPhone in the spring of 2027 (not autumn 2026).

Against the backdrop of a rising sales composition ratio for AI/DC, Apple's (exposure) impact on Apple-related stocks appears to be on a declining trend compared to in the past. Individual moves among related stocks that are particularly noteworthy in our view are **(1) Murata Mfg. (Buy, on CL)**: For RF, we surmise that content is high in base models, and there is a possibility that seasonal adjustments in January–March 2027 will be milder than usual. The company is also aiming for further market share recovery in the 2027 iPhone models. **TDK (Buy)**: In line with new phone model launches, the ratio of single battery cells to pack sales (high unit price) has been on an upward trend every year, and the ASP effect from the rising mix is having a positive impact, outweighing volume. **Nitto Denko (Neutral)**: For foldables, the company's entry into optical films will likely remain marginal in 2026, as the company aims to capture further demand in 2027. In addition, **Alps Alpine (Neutral)** and **Japan Aviation Electronics (Sell)** are among companies with relatively high sales composition ratios to Apple (see chart).

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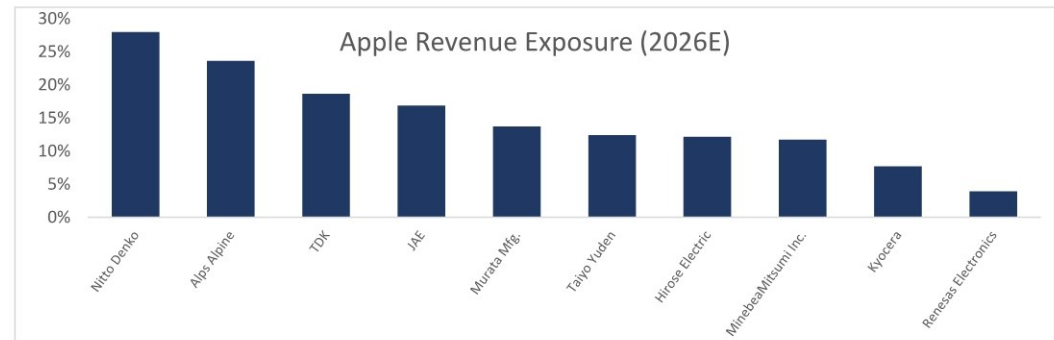
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Exhibit 1: Sales ratio to Apple for coverage companies (based on our FY3/27E estimates)

Our estimates based on the latest data disclosed by companies.

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: Announcement date/pre-order start date/release date/price of iPhone 18 series and iPhone 17 series

Model	iPhone Duo	iPhone17 Pro	iPhone 17 Pro Max	iPhone 17	iPhone Air	iPhone17 Pro	iPhone 17 Pro Max
Launch Date	9/10/2026	9/10/2026	9/10/2026			9/10/2025	
Pre-order Date	10/16/2026	9/12/2026	9/12/2026			9/12/2025	
Release Date	10/23/2026	9/18/2026	9/18/2026			9/19/2025	
Price (USD)	\$1,999	\$1,199	\$1,299	\$799	\$999	\$1,099	\$1,199

Announcement dates/pre-order start dates/release dates are based on US local time.

Source: Company data, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Price Target Risks and Methodology

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Murata Mfg.

Valuation methodology: We are Buy rated on Murata Mfg. with a 12-month price target of ¥12,900. Our target price is based on a FY3/29E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, applying an 80% premium to our sector multiple of 10X (implies FY3/29E P/E of 30X).

Key risks: Decline in smartphone production volume, deterioration in MLCC supply/demand, and yen appreciation.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - TDK

Valuation methodology: We are Buy rated on TDK with a 12-month price target of ¥4,900. Our target price is based on a FY3/29E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, applying a 10% premium to our sector average EV/DACF multiple of 10X (implies FY3/28E P/E of 27X).

Key risks: Decline in smartphone production volume, higher input costs, and yen appreciation.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Nitto Denko

We are Neutral rated on Nitto Denko, with a 12-month price target of ¥3,200. Our target price is based on a FY3/29E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, applying the sector average multiple of 10X with a 40% discount (our target price implies FY3/28E P/E of 14X).

Key risks include material cost fluctuations, FX fluctuations, a demand fluctuations for smartphones/PCs/tablets primarily in North America, etc.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Alps Alpine

We are Neutral rated on Alps Alpine with a 12-month price target of ¥2,200. Our target price is based on a FY3/29E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, applying a 60% discount to the sector average EV/DACF multiple of 10X (TP implies FY3/28E P/E of 11X).

Key risks include +/- fluctuations in automobile production, cost of materials and logistics, competition in the actuator market, exchange rates.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Japan Aviation Electronics Industry

We are Sell rated on Japan Aviation Electronics Industry, with a 12-month price target of ¥2,000. Our target price is based on a FY3/29E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, applying a 60% discount to our sector average EV/DACF multiple of 10X (our TP implies FY3/28E P/E of 16X).

Key risks include increased interest in aerospace themes, strengthening of the relationship with Kyocera, upside in smartphone and automotive production, declining material costs.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

We, Daiki Takayama, Mitsuhiro Ichio, Makoto Takahara and Yuji Hidaka, hereby certify that all of the views expressed in this report accurately reflect our personal views about the subject company or companies and its or their securities. We also certify that no part of our compensation was, is or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or views expressed in this report.

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Alps Alpine (Neutral, ¥2,124), Japan Aviation Electronics Industry (Sell, ¥2,448), Murata Mfg. (Buy, ¥7,128), Nitto Denko (Neutral, ¥3,175) and TDK (Buy, ¥2,813)

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Goldman Sachs has received compensation for non-investment banking services during the past 12 months: Murata Mfg. (¥7,128)

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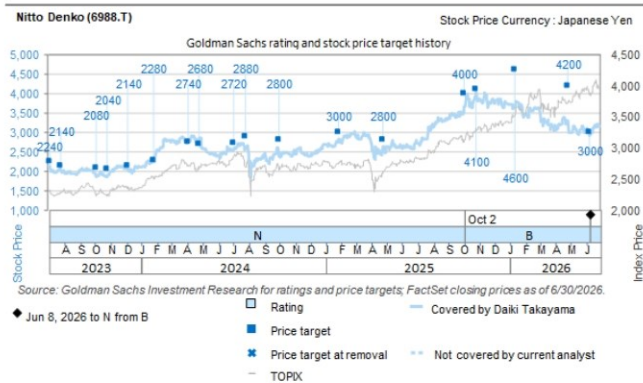
Distribution of ratings/investment banking relationships

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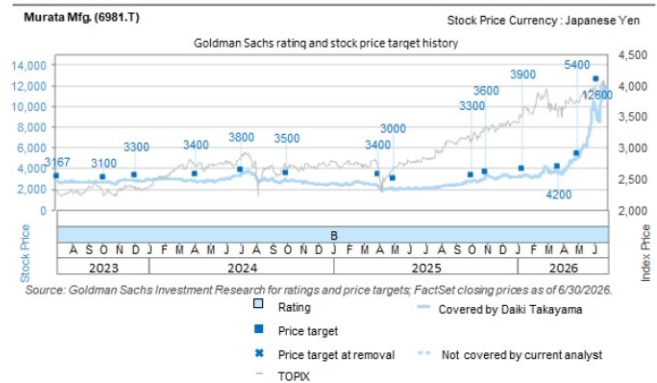
	Rating Distribution				Investment Banking Relationships		
	Buy	Hold	Sell		Buy	Hold	Sell
Global	50%	34%	16%		65%	59%	43%

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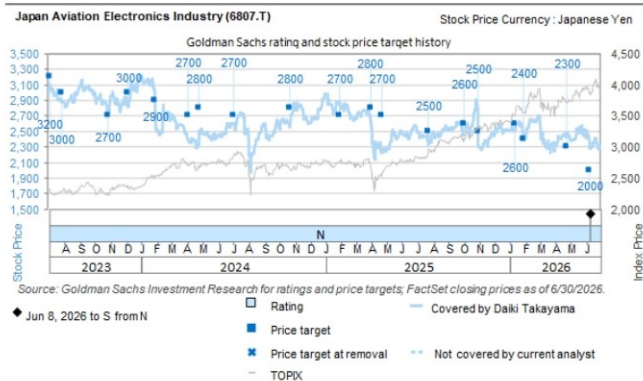
Price target and rating history chart(s)



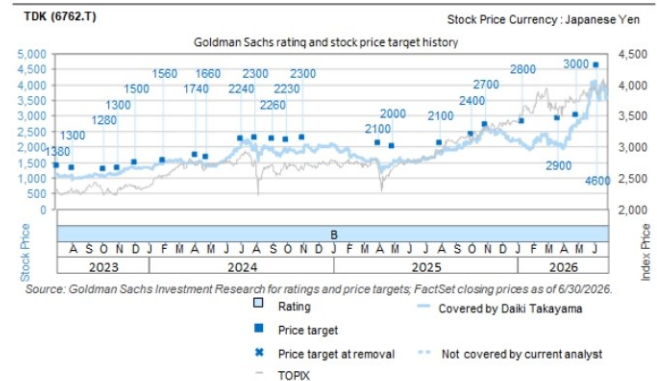
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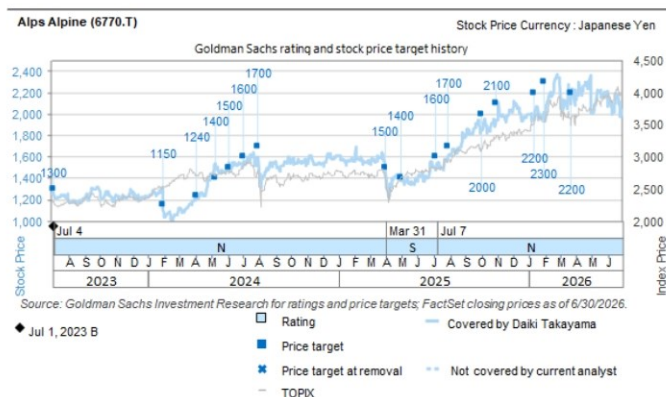
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Target price history table(s)

Alps Alpine (6770.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
23-Mar-26	2,200	2,101
30-Jan-26	2,300	2,015
12-Jan-26	2,200	1,942
31-Oct-25	2,100	1,946
02-Oct-25	2,000	1,857
31-Jul-25	1,700	1,600
07-Jul-25	1,600	1,478
30-Apr-25	1,400	1,448
31-Mar-25	1,500	1,521
31-Jul-24	1,700	1,603
02-Jul-24	1,600	1,525
05-Jun-24	1,500	1,549
09-May-24	1,400	1,541
03-Apr-24	1,240	1,202
30-Jan-24	1,150	1,307

Murata Mfg. (6981.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
31-Jul-26	12,900	7,416
08-Jun-26	12,600	8,711
30-Apr-26	5,400	5,156
23-Mar-26	4,200	3,508
12-Jan-26	3,900	3,194
31-Oct-25	3,600	3,392
02-Oct-25	3,300	2,770
30-Apr-25	3,000	2,214
31-Mar-25	3,400	2,306
01-Oct-24	3,500	2,893
02-Jul-24	3,800	3,364
03-Apr-24	3,400	2,768
06-Dec-23	3,300	2,892
04-Oct-23	3,100	2,657

TDK (6762.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
31-Jul-26	4,900	3,008
08-Jun-26	4,600	3,715
28-Apr-26	3,000	2,677
23-Mar-26	2,900	2,043
12-Jan-26	2,800	2,142
31-Oct-25	2,700	2,673
02-Oct-25	2,400	2,154
01-Aug-25	2,100	1,876
28-Apr-25	2,000	1,460
31-Mar-25	2,100	1,546
01-Nov-24	2,300	1,848
01-Oct-24	2,230	1,948
02-Sep-24	11,300	2,023
30-Jul-24	11,500	2,029
02-Jul-24	11,200	2,004
26-Apr-24	8,300	1,462
03-Apr-24	8,700	1,488
31-Jan-24	7,800	1,488
06-Dec-23	7,500	1,338
01-Nov-23	6,500	1,158
04-Oct-23	6,400	1,052

Japan Aviation Electronics Industry (6807.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
08-Jun-26	2,000	2,381
24-Apr-26	2,300	2,484
28-Jan-26	2,400	2,476
12-Jan-26	2,600	2,518
30-Oct-25	2,500	2,807
02-Oct-25	2,600	2,459
23-Jul-25	2,500	2,450
23-Apr-25	2,700	2,283
31-Mar-25	2,800	2,609
29-Jan-25	2,700	2,893
23-Oct-24	2,800	2,553
02-Jul-24	2,700	2,611
24-Apr-24	2,800	2,331
03-Apr-24	2,700	2,392
29-Jan-24	2,900	3,040
06-Dec-23	3,000	2,850
27-Oct-23	2,700	2,750

Nitto Denko (6988.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
28-Jul-26	3,200	3,446
08-Jun-26	3,000	3,008
27-Apr-26	4,200	3,302
12-Jan-26	4,600	3,630
27-Oct-25	4,100	4,068
02-Oct-25	4,000	3,491
25-Apr-25	2,800	2,630
27-Jan-25	3,000	2,820
01-Oct-24	2,800	2,489
26-Jul-24	14,400	2,565
02-Jul-24	13,600	2,550
26-Apr-24	13,400	2,851
03-Apr-24	13,700	2,756
26-Jan-24	11,400	2,251
06-Dec-23	10,700	2,077
26-Oct-23	10,200	1,860
04-Oct-23	10,400	1,863

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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